

Anthropic is here to play with OpenAI and Google chatbots

For the last couple of years, the GenAI buzz has behaved like Indian Premier League or English Premier League matchdays on X.com. Where fans of two teams declare rivalries and spend the rest of the season trying to prove who's better. In the case of AI, those two rival camps have firmly been ChatGPT vs Gemini. OpenAI's swagger versus Google's inevitable "hold my TPU."

And beyond all that noise, Claude has been doing the most unglamorous thing in tech – winning quietly.

Here's one crazy number: Menlo Ventures' 2025 enterprise survey puts Anthropic at 40% of enterprise LLM spend, ahead of OpenAI at 27% and Google at 21% – I was shocked to learn this too. Because in 2023, OpenAI reportedly sat near 50% while Anthropic was 12% of spend. That's beyond just gathering momentum, but a category leader challenge happening in real time from Claude.

The second key metric? Coding. Menlo estimates Claude now holds 54% of the coding market versus 21% by OpenAI, driven in large part by the popularity of Claude Code.

Which, honestly, matches what software engineers have been hyping for a year, if you bothered to pay attention. Claude isn't just "good at code." It's good at the stuff *around* code – understanding repo, finding elusive bugs, getting into the weeds of coding like an actual human would. Claude has been consistently outranking ChatGPT in this department for some time now.

And the business story backs it up. Reuters reports Anthropic is targeting \$9 billion in annualized revenue by end-2025, with enterprise customers driving nearly 80% of revenue. The funding narrative is equally unsubtle, because just in September 2025, Anthropic announced a \$13B Series F at a \$183B post-money valuation.

That's the part many people miss about Anthropic and Claude. Consumer mindshare is still largely dominated by a ChatGPT/Gemini



"If Claude Code is the developer who can ship, Cowork sounds like the ops teammate who can actually close the loop."

Jayesh Shinde
Executive Editor



Let me know your thoughts on this column at:
jayesh.shinde@digit.in | @jshinde

world. But in the enterprise game, nobody buys a model because it's charismatic. They buy it because it behaves, it integrates, and complies to all the operating rules – which has been Claude's forte all along.

Anthropic's own announcements lean hard into that reality. The company says it now serves 300,000+ business customers, and it's expanding Google Cloud TPU capacity to meet demand. And as far as 2026 resolutions go, Claude isn't stopping at "copilot." It's leaning into "coworker."

Reports indicate Anthropic is pushing Claude Code's agentic momentum into a broader tool called Cowork – aimed at the non-coding grind: the inbox-juggling, spreadsheet-shuffling, Slack-to-Salesforce glue work that quietly eats half our week. If Claude Code is the developer who can ship, Cowork sounds like the ops teammate who can actually close the loop. Not by writing a prettier email, but by doing the boring middle steps you forgot existed.

Yes, we should be allergic to hype. Gartner has warned that a big chunk of "agentic AI projects" could get scrapped by 2027 because many are expensive experiments with unclear ROI – and there's plenty of "agent-washing" in the market.

But that's exactly why Claude's rise feels... credible. It isn't begging you to believe in magic. It's showing you adoption curves, enterprise dollars, and tooling that developers actually keep installed. It's pushing the boundaries – while mostly skipping the controversy Olympics and the exaggerated exuberance.

So sure, let ChatGPT and Gemini have the blockbuster rivalry posters. Claude's been in the background, stacking wins like it's playing a different sport entirely. And if Cowork delivers on even half the promise, 2026 won't be about which chatbot is funnier. It'll be about which one quietly became part of your org chart. **■**